

Day 12 – Microsoft Entra ID Password Protection & Smart Lockout

Objective

Learn how Microsoft Entra ID protects user accounts from password attacks by reviewing Password Protection and Smart Lockout settings.

Skills You'll Learn

- Password Protection
- Smart Lockout
- Password Security
- Identity Protection Concepts
- Microsoft Entra Administration

Step 1 – Open Password Protection

Go to:

Microsoft Entra admin center

→ Protection

→ Authentication methods

→ Password protection

If you don't see "Protection", use the search bar at the top and search for **Password protection**.

 Screenshot 1

- Password Protection Overview

Home > Salesforce | Sign-in logs > Authentication methods

Authentication methods | Password protection

Default Directory - Microsoft Entra ID Security

Search Save Discard

Manage

- Policies
- Password protection**
- Registration campaign
- Authentication strengths
- Settings

Monitoring

- Activity
- User registration details
- Registration and reset events
- Bulk operation results
- Bulk operation results (Preview)

Some features on this page require a Microsoft Entra ID Premium license. Click here to upgrade.

Custom smart lockout

Lockout threshold 10

Lockout duration in seconds 60

Custom banned passwords

Enforce custom list Yes No

Custom banned password list

Password protection for Windows Server Active Directory

Enable password protection on Windows Server Active Directory Yes No

Mode Enforced Audit

Step 2 – Review Smart Lockout

Review the following settings (if visible):

- Lockout threshold
- Lockout duration
- Custom banned passwords
- Password protection mode

Do **not** change any settings unless you want to test them.

Screenshot 2

- Smart Lockout Settings

Authentication methods | Password protection

Default Directory - Microsoft Entra ID Security

Search

Save Discard

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Bulk operation results

Bulk operation results (Preview)

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Lockout threshold

10

Lockout duration in seconds

60

Custom banned passwords

Enforce custom list

Yes

No

Custom banned password list

Password protection for Windows Server Active Directory

Enable password protection on Windows Server Active Directory

Yes

No

Mode

Enforced

Audit

Step 3 – Review Password Protection

Read the available options and note:

- What custom banned passwords are
- How Microsoft blocks weak passwords
- How Smart Lockout helps prevent password spray attacks

Screenshot 3

- Password Protection Configuration



Authentication methods | Password protection

Default Directory - Microsoft Entra ID Security

Search

Save Discard

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Audit

Step 4 – Document Your Findings

Record the following in your README:

- What Password Protection does.
- What Smart Lockout does.
- Why they are important for IAM.